Travel Agents: Taiwan — Rules

Two rival travel agents race to build the island's best Taiwan food tour in one eating day. Ride between four regions, dig up ingredients, and pile Buzz on the vendors you want. Win a vendor by out-hyping your rival on the spot — each becomes a stop on your tour and makes the next one cheaper. Your only points are Tour Tickets: finish the most before the last train and you're Top Agent.

> These are real Taiwanese dishes and night markets — celebrated with care. Eat them with a grin.

1. What you're going for

Your score is your Tour Tickets, and nothing else. Vendors, Buzz, and Reach never score — they're your engine. Most ticket points at the end wins the season and the title of Top Agent (§8).

2. Setup

> 🖼 [FIG-SETUP] — annotated board (see art brief). Callouts: ① region decks · ② vendor slots · ③ Reach & Tours-Completed tracks · ④ Buzz supply — everyone starts in Taipei.

- ① The map — four regions in a ring: North 北 · Central 中 · South 南 · East 東, with an HSR line linking North↔South. Each region gets a face-down vendor deck and a face-down ingredient deck. Split every deck into a DAY and a NIGHT pile; shuffle the DAY piles into place and set the NIGHT piles aside for dusk. (Drinks are just cheap vendors mixed through both.)
- ② Vendor slots — fill the face-up slots: 2 in the North, 1 elsewhere.
- Each ingredient deck holds its signature — N 豬肉 · C 茶 · S 海鮮 · E 米, plus common K 糖 in Central & South only — and a few events. Seed the two 排班保養 Scheduled Maintenance cards into the North and South NIGHT ingredient decks (§6).
- ③ Tracks — every Reach marker to 2, every Tours Completed counter to 0.
- ④ Buzz supply — a shared pool (about 24 for two players).
- Tour Tickets — shuffle the DAY deck, draw 5 (box the rest), reveal 3 as the shared row (the other 2 are its draw pile). Set the NIGHT deck aside for dusk.
- Each agent takes an Agent Character (read its ability + flaw aloud), a pawn in Taipei, and an empty Larder kept face-up all game.

3. Your turn

Take ONE action. Then, if your Larder holds more than 7 ingredients, discard down to 7.

> 🖼 [FIG-TURN] — the six actions as an icon row (see art brief).

- VISIT THE LOCAL MARKET (where you stand) — flip the top 3 of this region's ingredient deck. Any event fires now (§6), then discards. Keep up to 2 ingredients.
- CONVENIENCE STORE (anywhere) — flip the top 1 of any region's ingredient deck: take the ingredient, or the event fires (§6).
- TRAVEL — move to a neighbour (HSR = North↔South), then flip the top 1 of the region you arrive in (event? nothing happens, keep moving). Gain +1 Reach.
- PROMOTE (with a vendor here) — place 2 Buzz from the supply onto vendor(s) you're standing with (§4). Buzz stays on the card, in full view — your rival can pile on too.
- BRIBE A VENDOR — win a face-up vendor you're standing with by out-hyping your rival (§5).
- LINE UP A TOUR TICKET — take one from the row of 3 (then refill). You may only take one you haven't already completed. It scores later (§8).

> Greedy Grab. On a Visit or a Convenience Store you may grab one extra ingredient beyond your limit — for −1 Reach (§4).

> **Agent Characters bend the rules.** Each mat has one ability and one flaw for that agent alone — where a mat disagrees with these rules, the mat wins.

4. Buzz & Reach — the hype fight

Buzz lives only in the supply or on a vendor — never in your hand. To Buzz a vendor you must stand in its region, and both agents can Buzz the same one.

> 🖼 [FIG-REACH] — committed Buzz on the board vs. your Reach marker (see art brief).
>
> **Your hype can't outrun your Reach.** Your total committed Buzz can never exceed your Reach (a marker starting at 2 — not a score). Travel and a few events raise it; winning a vendor clears your Buzz off it, freeing the cap again. To out-escalate a contested vendor, you first need the Reach to cover the whole stack.

Reach also gets spent: a Greedy Grab costs −1, and a couple of events (a bad review, a mix-up) ding it too. It never drops below 0. (If Reach would fall below your committed Buzz, see the FAQ.)

5. Bribing a vendor

To Bribe a face-up vendor, all at once: 1. be with it, in its region; 2. hold at least 2 more Buzz on it than your rival (checked right now); 3. pay its ingredients, minus your region discounts.

> 🖼 [FIG-BRIBE] — the three steps, then the vendor joining your tour (see art brief).

Take the vendor onto your tour. If it completes a Tour Ticket you hold, flip that ticket to its done side and slide your Tours Completed counter up one (§7). Then clear ALL Buzz on the vendor — yours and your rival's — to the supply, refill the slot, and move the day-clock +1 (§7). The vendor is now locked to you.

What a vendor is. A vendor shows a Draw number (人氣) and either a region icon or none. Draw isn't a score — it just feeds the tickets that ask for it and marks the big prizes. Each region icon you hold makes that region's ingredients 1 cheaper on future vendors — that's your engine. Drinks and the ★ apex have no icon, and Buzz is never discounted. Night stalls cost more than day ones and each needs two regions' ingredients, so one region's ramp helps you afford them but never makes them free. Out-hyped first? Your Buzz just fizzles back to the supply — you keep everything you dug up and lose only the stop.

> Rave Reviews 好評. The first time you reach your 2nd completed tour, gain +1 Reach; the first time you reach your 4th, take 1

ingredient of your choice and your next Bribe costs 1 less ingredient. One-time each, and each agent earns their own.

6. Markets, events & the day-clock

Each region's ingredient deck holds its signature (plus common K in two regions) and a few events, mostly hazards. Working a market — a Visit or a Convenience Store — fires any event you flip, right away. A card flipped as you arrive on a Travel does nothing. - Hazards (most events) tax or delay — they never destroy what you hold or cost you a whole turn. - Boons (the rest) hand out Buzz, or make a vendor get hot (a ★, below).

🖼 [FIG-SCOPE] — the three event scopes (see art brief).

Who an event hits — read from the region the card came out of: ⦿ You · ⬢ This region (everyone standing there) · ➤ Next door (a neighbour). On a Convenience Store you're often elsewhere, so ⬢ can land on your rival — never a personal attack, just the island living its life.

排班保養 Scheduled Maintenance (island-wide — its own banner, not a ⦿/⬢/➤ card). The HSR is down for everyone. Place it on the HSR line. Until the start of your next turn, North and South aren't linked — everyone Travels the long way round (N→C→S or N→E→S). Then discard it; the HSR reopens.

★ Star vendors. Some night-market names print a ★ (a real Michelin / Bib-Gourmand nod): the top Draw, no region icon, one

apex per region. A boon can also drop a ★ Star token on a vendor, making it worth +2 Draw to whoever wins it.

7. Day → Night

It's one eating day, and the day-clock climbs +1 every time anyone Bribes a vendor. It has two marks (for two players: dusk = the 5th win · last train = the 10th; both grow with more players).

> 🖼 [FIG-CLOCK] — the day-clock with its dusk and last-train marks (see art brief).

- Act I · Daytime 白天 — morning food and drinks; build your discount ramp. Daytime tickets are on offer.
- DUSK (the clock hits the dusk mark) — all at once: judge every claimed daytime ticket (done → win pile · unfinished → lose pile), clear the whole day layer island-wide, reveal each region's night decks, and swap the ticket row to the nighttime pool. Keep your Larder; unclaimed day vendors are gone.
- Act II · Night Market 夜市 — the big stalls: pricier, fought-over, the ★ apex.
- LAST TRAIN (the clock hits the last-train mark) — everyone heads home: finish the current round, play one more full round, and stop.

8. Scoring

Reveal both piles and tally once: - + the printed value of each ticket in your WIN pile (成團) — the tours that ran. - − floor(value ÷ 2) for each ticket in your LOSE pile (遺珠) — the ones that got away.

Vendors, Draw, and Reach score nothing. Most points is Top Agent. Ties: most vendors, then most regions covered, then fewest tickets in your lose pile.

FAQ

- My Reach would drop below the Buzz I already committed. A Greedy Grab that would do this simply isn't allowed. If an event forces it, return Buzz from the board to the supply — your choice which — until your committed Buzz is back within your Reach. Reach never goes below 0.
- An ingredient deck runs out. Reshuffle its discard — ingredients never leave the game.
- A vendor slot's deck is empty. Leave the slot unfilled until the next flip refills it. If every deck dries up island-wide, that phase ends immediately.
- One Bribe trips dusk and the last train at once. Resolve dusk first, then check the end.
- Do drinks or big-Draw vendors score? No. Only Tour Tickets score — vendors are pure engine.

Iconography — the flip-to legend

Every glyph on the cards, tokens, and board. Shapes are drawn, so they read by shape + 繁體 label, never colour alone.

Ingredients (the 5 tokens)



Pork 豬肉
North signature · hexagon



Tea 茶
Central signature · triangle



Seafood 海鮮
South signature · square



Rice 米
East signature · circle



Sugar 糖
The common (C & S only) · beam

The four regions



North 北
vermilion · triangle · pork



Central 中
jade · diamond · tea



South 南
amber · circle · seafood



East 東
indigo · square · rice

Event scope — who it hits



⊙ You
self — only the flipper



⬢ This region
everyone standing in the drawn region



➤ Next door
spills into a neighbouring region

Day / Night

Day 日 · 早
warm morning layer — breakfast run

Night 夜 · 市
neon night-market layer (after dusk)

Currencies & scoring

Buzz 讚
the hype you pile on a vendor

★ Apex / Star
top prize per region; a Star adds value

Prestige
a vendor's point value (your score)

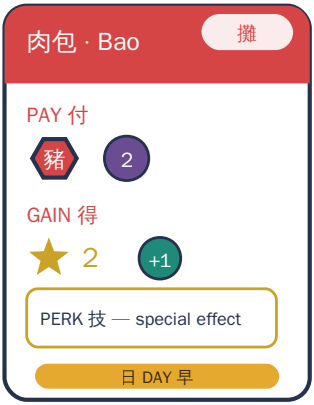
Reputation 譽
your standing — scores by final position

The two ticket piles

成團 · Win pile
tours that ran: gain printed value

遺珠 · Lose pile
got away: lose half the value

Vendor card — layout key



① Header band = region colour + emblem + dish name

② PAY 付 = ingredient chips (shape+繁體) + Buzz neede

③ GAIN 得 = Prestige (★) + Reputation (譽) + perk

④ PERK 技 = the vendor's special bonus

⑤ Phase ribbon = day 日 / night 夜 (which layer)

Top-right pill = venue tier (攤 stall · 小吃 · 名店)

★ printed = an apex / Star vendor (top prize)